

PRODUCT DESIGN CASE STUDY

Fintech

Consumer Banking

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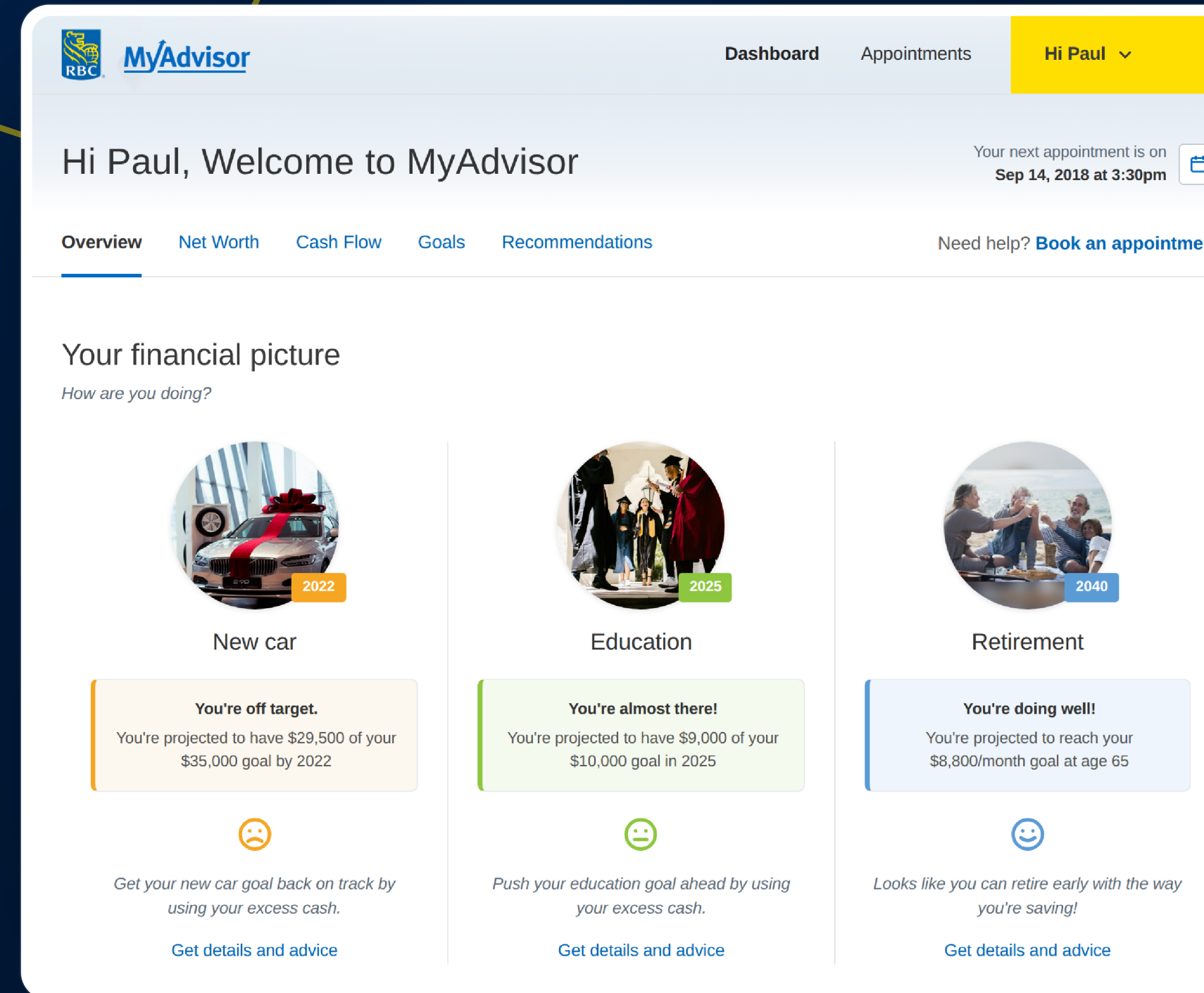
RBC MyAdvisor

A guided, co-managed advice experience: turning a dense financial-planning tool into one connected picture for clients and advisors.

"Omni-channel continuity between client and advisor."

Margaux Kan | Senior Product Design Manager

This case study reflects work completed in my role as a Senior Product Designer.



Clients, advisors, and the disconnected picture MyAdvisor replaced

Quick context before the story: who the clients are, what MyAdvisor does, and how the old experience worked.

RETAIL CLIENTS

The customers

Individual banking clients across all wealth tiers, from early savers to near-retirement, wanting to know if their finances are on track without parsing dense reports themselves.

MYADVISOR

The platform

A connected advice platform combining net worth, cash flow, and goals into one dashboard, with a direct line to a human advisor.

THE OLD PROCESS

Scattered and disconnected

Net worth, cash flow, and goals lived apart. Nothing told clients whether they were on track to meet their financial goals, and the advice relationship sat disconnected from the data.

"Replace a dense, advisor-built planning tool with a shared experience that answers one question for every client: 'am I on track to meet my financial goals?', and connects every insight to a human advisor."

Business mission

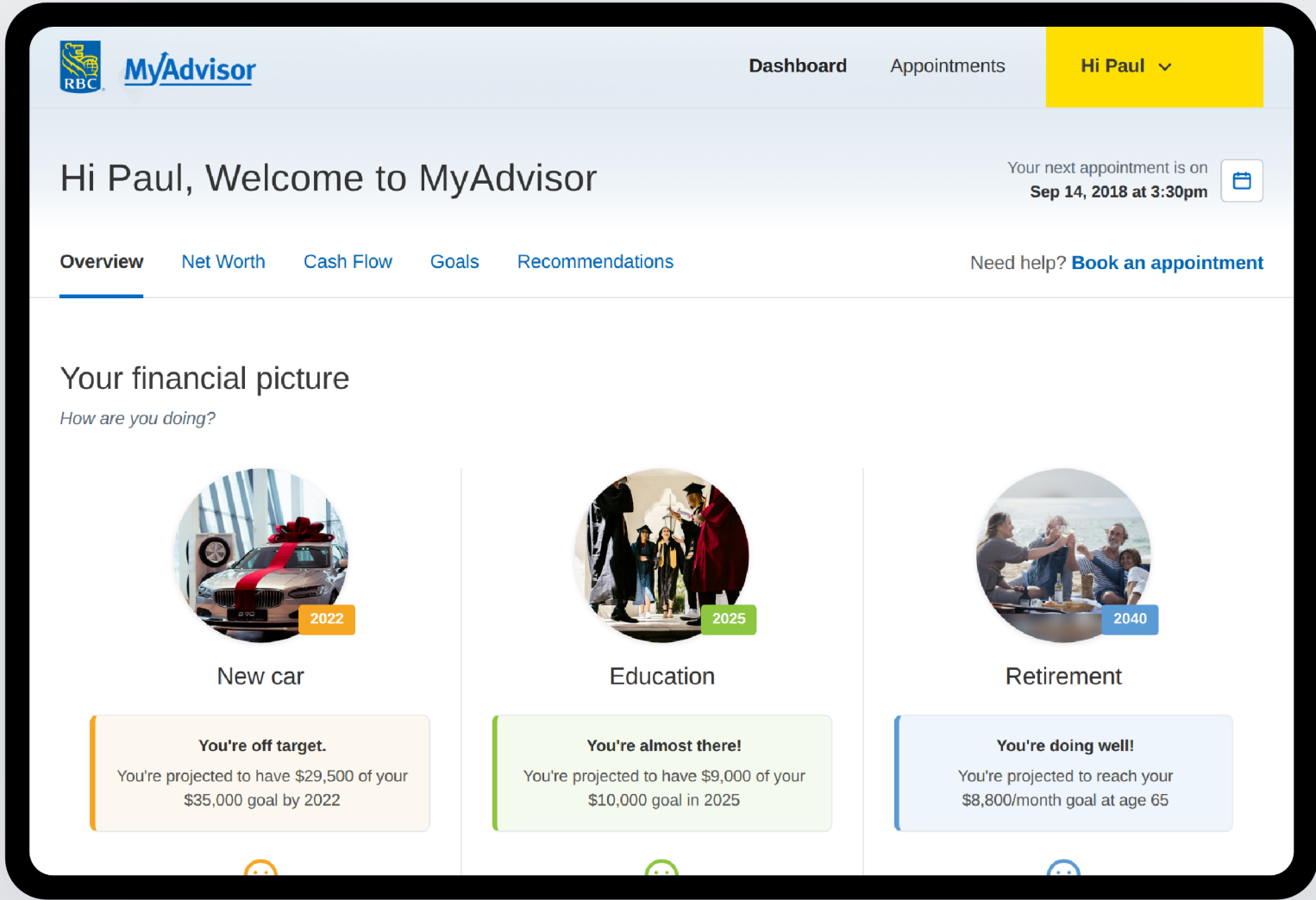
Turning dense financial planning into a guided, connected experience

MY ROLE

- Led end-to-end design for MyAdvisor, RBC's client-facing financial advice platform
- Partnered with Product, Engineering, Legal, Compliance, and financial advisors to turn a dense tool into a guided experience
- Defined the vision, drove alignment, and facilitated delivery across teams

OUTCOME

Gave clients a clear, plain-language view of their whole financial life, and a one-tap path to their advisor — reducing confusion, drop-off, and advice that felt disconnected from the numbers.



22%

Of testers said the score made their finances feel clearer

+18%

More clients booked or messaged an advisor

-34%

Drop in time to answer "am I on track?"

A trusted institution, still speaking in numbers, not answers

RBC
Canada's Largest Financial Institution

MYADVISOR
Digital Advice Platform

PRIMARY PERSONAS

Digital advice needed to work for two very different people at once

Retail Clients

Wanted to understand their finances in plain language, and to know if they were on track — not parse raw numbers themselves.

Advisors

Needed clients to arrive informed, with shared context, so conversations could start further ahead.

From early savers to near-retirement clients across all wealth tiers — a mass-affluent base RBC serves at national scale.

05 / 9 FRAME · STRATEGIC PROBLEM & BUSINESS RISK

1 UNDERSTAND — 2 FRAME — 3 EXPLORE — 4 VALIDATE — 5 DELIVER

Data visualization that enables advisors to explain complex finances and empowers clients to self-assess

Executive framing: making net worth, cash flow, and assets understandable for people planning toward retirement.

THE PROBLEM

Net worth, cash flow, and assets were presented as raw figures, with no translation into what they meant for the goals clients were actually planning for — retirement above all. The data lived apart from the goals, and the advice relationship sat disconnected from both.

"I can see all the numbers. I just don't know if I'm on track to meet my financial goals."

Client feedback

BUSINESS RISK: WHY IT MATTERED

-  **Eroded trust**
An unclear picture pushed clients to disengage from planning.
-  **Missed advice moments**
Disconnected data meant fewer, lower-quality advisor conversations.
-  **Lost lifetime value**
Drop-off early in the relationship erodes long-term growth.

CROSS-FUNCTIONAL & TECHNICAL

Framing this risk meant aligning Product, Engineering, Legal, Compliance, and financial advisors around a shared root cause — that fragmented data was both a UX and a business problem.

EXECUTIVE FRAMING

This wasn't a UI refresh. It was a trust, retention, and advice-quality problem worth solving at the platform level.

Driving strategy across disciplines

WHAT I LED

- Ran stakeholder discovery workshops to define what financial data to capture and how to display it
- Designed the connected dashboard linking net worth, cash flow, goals, and advice
- Led user research across digital and in-branch advice journeys
- Created the service blueprint used across Product, Engineering, Legal, and financial advisors

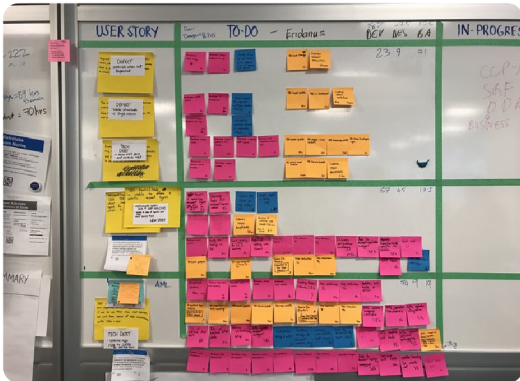
HOW I SHOWED LEADERSHIP

- Aligned cross-functional partners: Product, Engineering, Legal, Compliance, and financial advisors
- Presented design rationale to senior stakeholders and compliance reviewers
- Owned delivery of design artifacts through ambiguity and scope change

WORKSHOPS & DELIVERY IN PRACTICE



Cross-functional design discovery workshop, working through research artifacts together.



Sprint board tracking delivery with Engineering, story by story.

Grounding the redesign in how clients actually read their finances

GOAL Validate where trust, comprehension, and advice broke down across the client's financial journey.

HOW I RESEARCHED

- Field interviews with 8 clients on how they read their finances today
- Card sorting and journey mapping with 5 advisors and branch staff
- Embedded working sessions with Legal, Product, and financial advisors



Usability lab, client interview



Research synthesis, affinity mapping

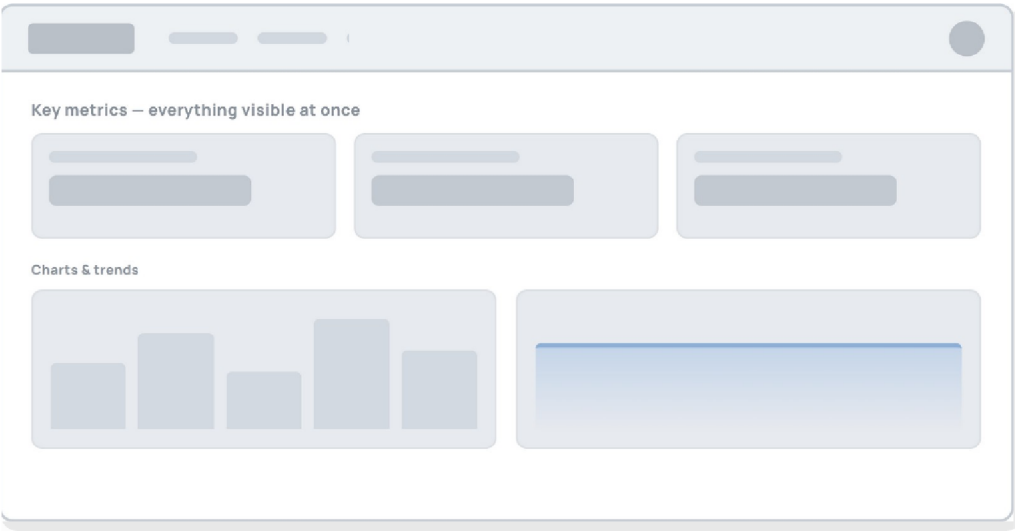
CLIENT JOURNEY				
MyAdvisor Service blueprint	01 Discover	02 Understand my picture	03 Explore the details	04 See what's next
	Web / Mobile	Web / Mobile	Web / Mobile	Web / Mobile
Client actions WHAT THE CLIENT DOES	• Logs into online banking, opens MyAdvisor	• Reads net worth & financial health score	• Reviews net worth, cash flow & goals over time	• Reads the
-- LINE OF INTERACTION --				
Frontstage VISIBLE TO CLIENT	• Personalized entry: "Welcome, Paul" + MyAdvisor card	• Health score + plain-language reassurance up front	• Net Worth / Cash Flow / Goals views with trends	• "Lift your s
-- LINE OF VISIBILITY --				
Backstage HIDDEN FROM CLIENT	• —	• —	• —	• High-value queue
-- LINE OF INTERNAL INTERACTION --				
Support systems DATA & PROCESSES	• Identity & auth: account linking	• Data aggregation: health-score engine	• Accounts data: projection engine	• Recommen

► Full service blueprint

TAKEAWAY *The service blueprint above (built from these interviews and workshops) became the shared reference for the redesign — it aligned Product, Engineering, Legal & financial advisors on one view of the client + advisor journey, and showed exactly where trust and comprehension were breaking down.*

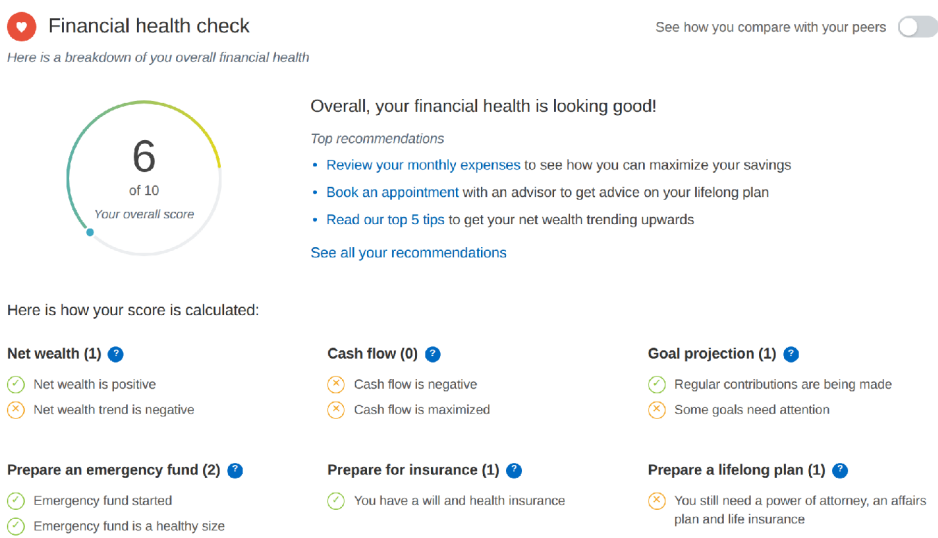
Two directions, stress-tested with clients before committing

GOAL Find the framing that actually built trust and reduced confusion, not just the cleanest screen.



Lead with the full data

Showed every metric at once: clear, but didn't answer “am I on track to meet my financial goals?”



Lead with one health score

Led with a single plain-language score, detail a tap away, mapped to what clients wanted to know.

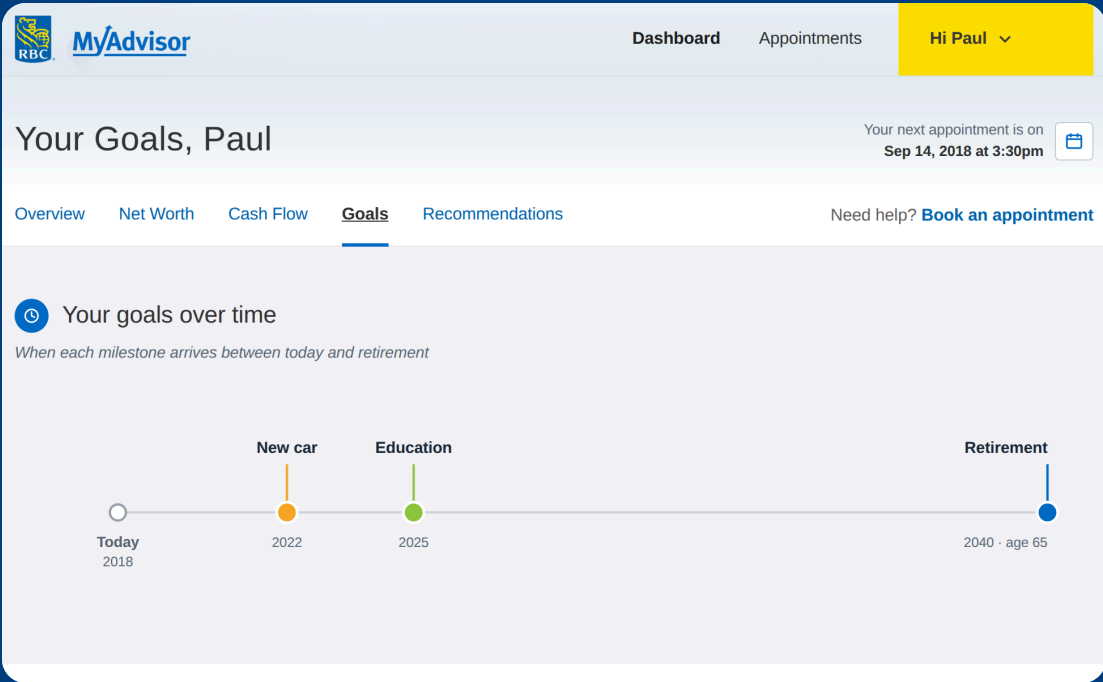
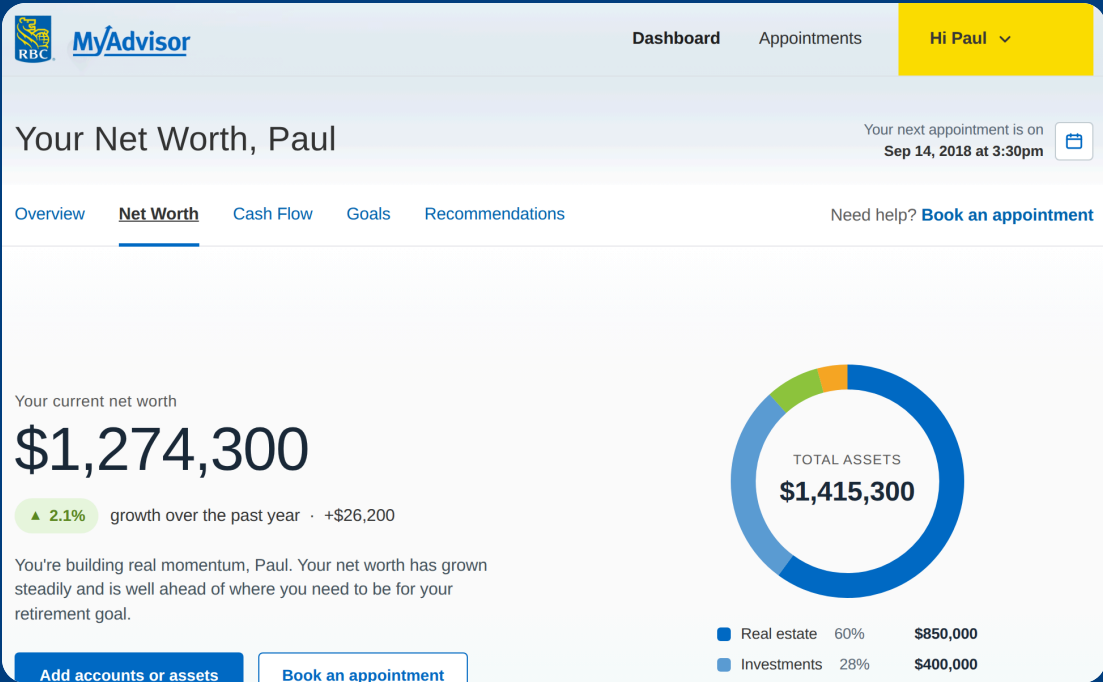
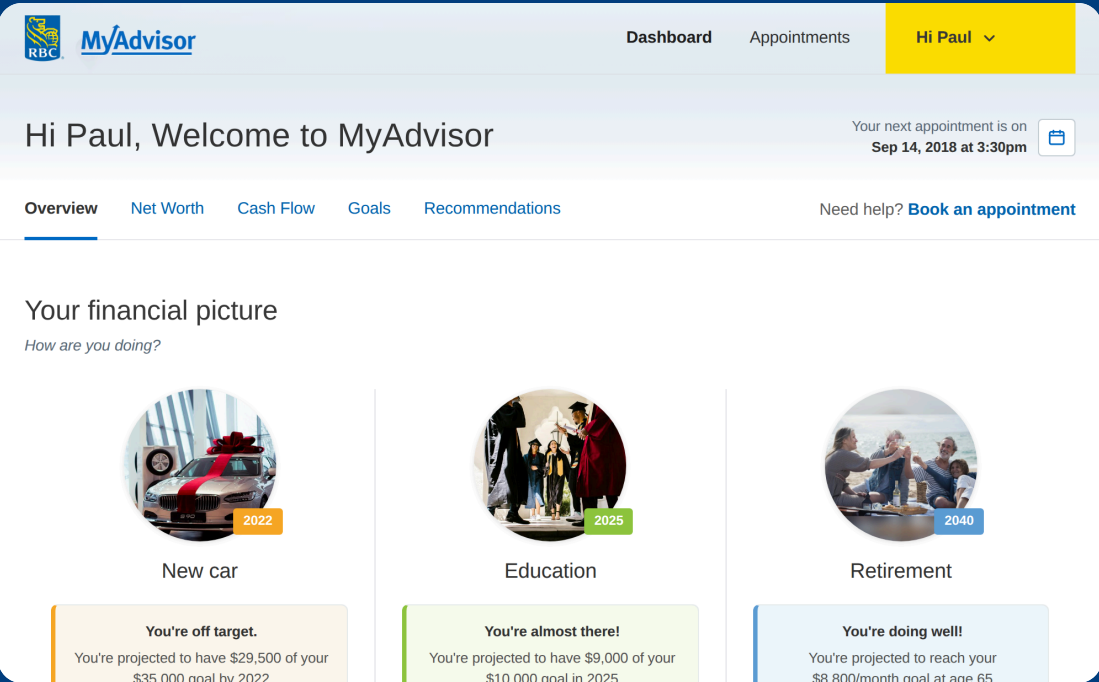
HOW THEY WERE TESTED

Moderated usability sessions with clients, walking through realistic scenarios like checking net worth or reviewing goals, and scored on clarity, trust, and comprehension.

Of the directions explored, leading with one plain-language health score, detail a tap away, answered “am I on track to meet my financial goals?” best without overwhelming clients.

A guided, co-managed advice experience

A connected dashboard that answers “am I on track to meet my financial goals?” in plain language, leads with one health score, and routes every insight to a human advisor.



22%

Of testers said the score made their finances feel clearer

+18%

More clients booked or messaged an advisor

−34%

Drop in time to answer “am I on track?”

 **Launch scope**
Soft-launched to a client cohort, then rolled out across national digital channels.

 **Design system impact**
Reusable data-viz and card patterns now used across RBC advice products.